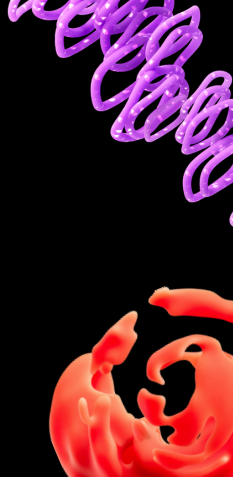


Trusted Adult Map

Identify and connect with supportive adults.



What is a Trusted Adult?

A trusted adult is someone you can rely on for support, guidance, and help when you need it. These individuals are typically mature, understanding, and have your best interests at heart. They can be a source of comfort, advice, and a safe space to share your thoughts and feelings, especially during challenging times.

Building a network of trusted adults is an essential part of emotional well-being. It's not about having just one person, but a variety of people in different areas of your life who can offer different kinds of support. Think of them as a safety net, ready to catch you if you fall and help you get back on your feet.

Who Can Be a Trusted Adult?

Family Members

- Parents or guardians
- Grandparents
- Aunts and uncles
- Older siblings
- Cousins

Community Members

- Neighbors
- Religious leaders (e.g., pastor, imam, rabbi)
- Youth group leaders
- Coaches from outside of school
- Mentors

School Staff

- Teachers
- School counselors
- Coaches
- Librarians
- Principal or vice-principal

Other Adults

- Friends' parents
- Family friends
- Therapists or counselors (outside of school)
- Doctors or nurses

Activity: Build Your Trusted Adult Map

Now it's time to create your personal trusted adult map. This is a visual representation of the people in your life who you can turn to. You can draw this, write it out, or use a digital tool.

Instructions:

1. **Central Point:** In the center of your map, write "Me" or draw a small picture of yourself.
2. **Outer Circles/Branches:** From the center, draw lines or branches outwards. At the end of each line, write the name of a trusted adult.
3. **Categorize:** If you wish, you can group adults by category (e.g., family, school, community) using different colors or sections.
4. **What They Offer:** Next to each name, you might want to jot down *why* you trust them or what kind of support they can offer. For example: "Mom - talks about feelings," "Mr. Smith (Teacher) - helps with homework," "Grandma - gives good advice."
5. **Emergency Contacts:** Make sure to include at least one adult who is readily available in case of an emergency.

Reflection Questions:

- Do you have adults in different categories? If not, who could you try to connect with more?
- Are there any situations where you feel you don't have a trusted adult to turn to? What could you do about that?
- How can you be a trusted adult for someone else?